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Paul's Training Manual Demo

Updated: February 2026

Overview

This manual is a demonstration and exploration of features you can incorporate into your own training library. Look around, don't be shy, and contact me with any questions you may have.

Features you can test include:

- Quick Word Search
- Table of Contents Navigation
- High-Resolution Single Page Screenshot Downloads
- Alternate PDF document viewing

Features available upon request:

- Document narration assistant
- Integrated videos and quizzes
- Integrated audio samples

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About this Manual

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Overview

You may be wondering how a manual like this is created and published and how I might work with your organization’s existing content. Below is a step-by-step breakdown of this process:

1. **Needs Assessment**

   Identify current issues you are experiencing with document control and distribution. Compose a list of required features you want your editors and end users to access.

2. **Document Governance & Review**

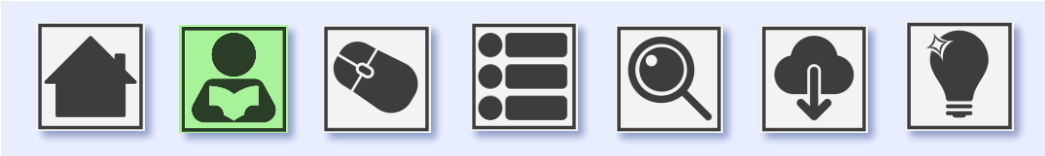
   Documents created, reviewed, and approved for publication by a small and focused governance team.

3. **Document Conversion**

   Once approved, these documents (PDFs, Word, etc…) are submitted to your content creator for HTML 5 conversion.

4. **Publication**

   The updated manual is published on your preferred hosting platform and is made available to your team.



About Me

Paul Nichols

Adult Education & Employee Training Designer

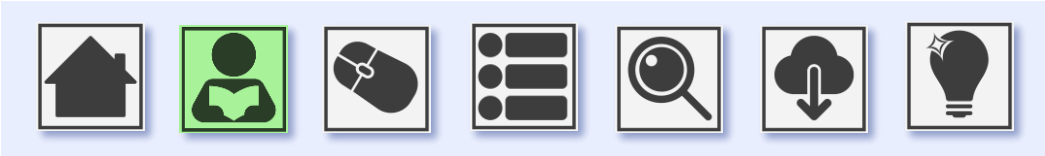
- *8+ years of experience in employee development*
- *Master's Degree in Adult Education (2020)*
- *Certified adult literacy tutor*
- *Audio, video, and document editor*
- *Software simulation designer*

As a legally blind learner, my passion for universal instructional design stems from my own personal investment in education. Very often, I encounter textbooks, presentations, manuals, and reference libraries that serve only a fraction of users at an optimum level. The rest face barriers to entry.

My mission is to maintain quality accessibility features throughout the learning process, no matter the platform. This allows employees to focus on their roles and responsibilities instead of the technical challenges they face while retrieving information.

At the same time, your editors and document controllers should have clear and simple methods to efficiently version and track updates as they move through the review process. These methods should for standard formatting, accuracy of information, and supplemental resources.

I have worked at a call center, a school district, a law firm, building maintenance, and even a zoo; so I can say with confidence that, no matter the industry, these needs prevail.



The “Why” Behind The Work

This manual was designed to address common frustrations in document versioning, management, and publishing that many organizations face, including:

- Unauthorized document editing
- The Download and Distribution of out-of-date materials
- Prolonged document search and load times
- Document formatting inconsistencies across departments

…and it looks pretty modern too!

Philosophy of Design

In my world, the fewer clicks it takes a user to access information, the better! This especially applies to live interactions with customers or urgent situations. Therefore, visual clarity, direct language, and an intuitive interface must all contribute to published work.

Create Separate Spaces

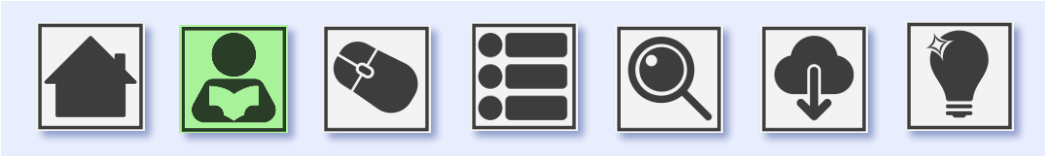
For best results, I recommend creating two separate spaces within your document library:

Editing & Versioning

This space should be invisible to your end users. It should be a private editing space where your designers can track document versioning and complete updates as needed. Once approved for publication, the document is then *copied* over to the User-Facing platform.

User-Facing Platform

In short, this manual is the user-facing platform, a front-facing interface holding the most current information. Here, you are not limited to a PDF or Word document. Instead, you can bring your content to life while stowing the originals elsewhere.



Using the Dashboard

There are several options available to you provided by the dashboard at the top of your screen, including:

Table of Contents

Select to toggle the Table of Contents.

Keyword Search

A quick search feature especially useful for larger documents.

Downloads

This feature offers document downloads as either a single-page screen shot or a complete PDF.

Page Navigation Buttons

Select to flip through the manual's pages. You can also use your mouse wheel.

Text Selection Tool

Selecting this option will toggle a text selection tool that can be used to highlight and copy text to your clipboard.

Full Screen Button

Selecting this option will toggle the manual from a windowed mode to full screen.

Zoom In / Out

While this is not a button on the dashboard, you can double-click to zoom in and out on any page. Click and drag your mouse to navigate.

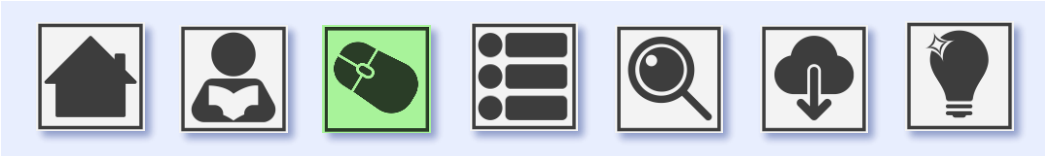
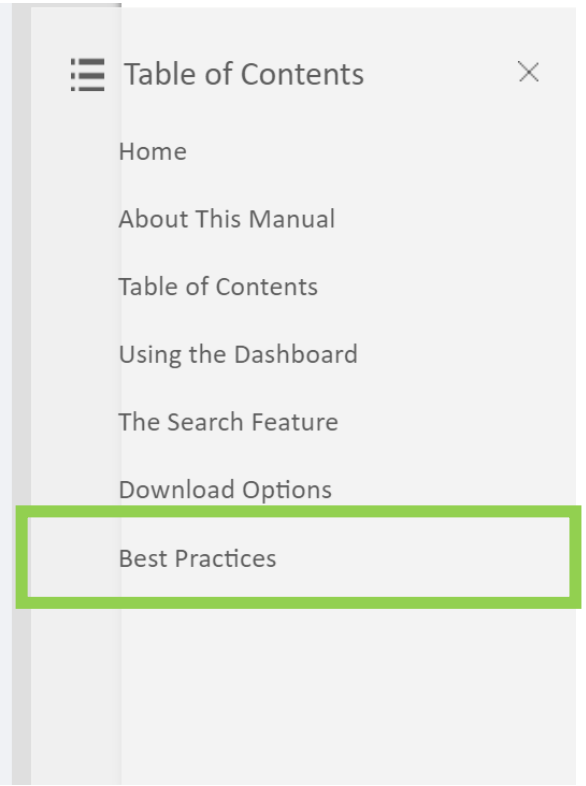


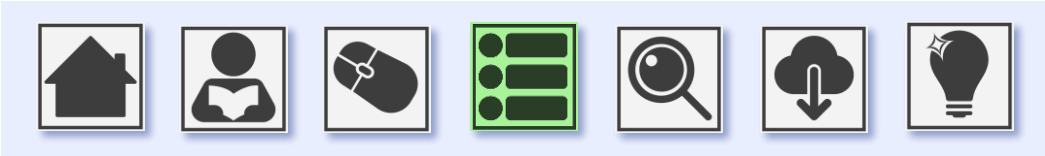
Table of Contents

The Table of Contents button is the first button on your dashboard. Selecting the button will toggle the Table of Contents for easy navigation.

Selecting any item from the Table of contents will automatically direct you to that section of the manual. In addition, the following may be added to the table for supplemental navigation:

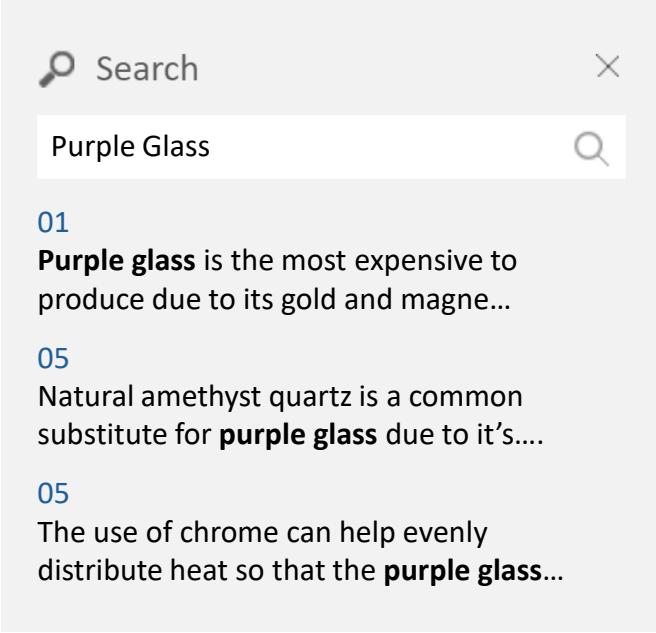
- Arrange your bookmarks into categories and sub-categories
- Web page links
- Links to other flipbook documents.



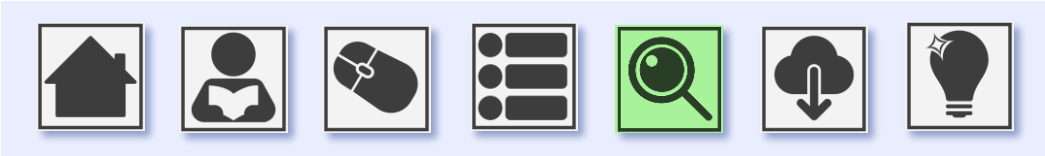


The Search Feature

The Search feature can be used to locate key words within the document.

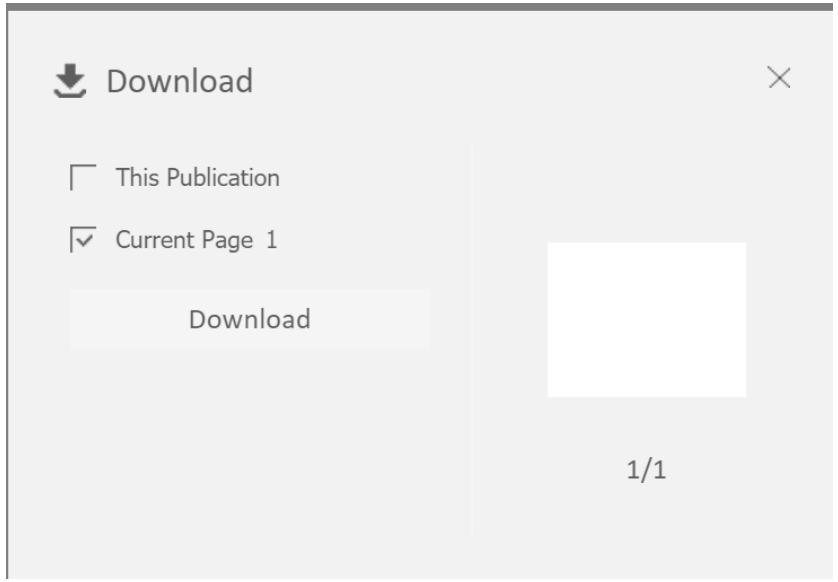


- A minimum of two (2) characters is required to execute key word search.
- Search results will be listed in page order below your entry.
- In the manual, results will be highlighted in Yellow
- Selecting a search result will redirect you to the page where it was found.

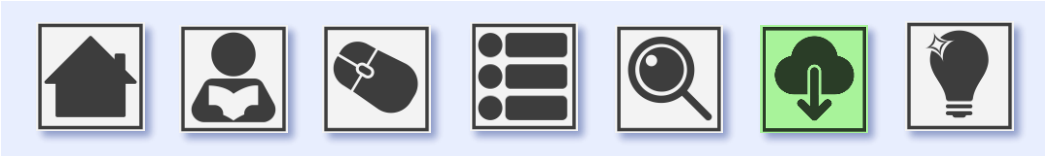


Download Options

The Downloads menu is an optional feature that enables users to select the full publication, or a single-page to save to their systems. A URL can be added as an additional option linking users to a file repository. Finally, individual attachments can be added to this menu such as videos, attestations, and notes.



- The full publication will be formatted as a PDF when saved.
- The current or selected page will be saved as a PNG image and can be copied / pasted into emails and team chats.
- If linked to a file repository such as SharePoint, your users must have the correct permissions within that system to view files.
- Individual attachments should be added on a supplementary basis only.



Best Practices

Schedule Regular Review Meetings

Schedule regular document review meetings following a standard submission and approval process.

This will transform your updates from “reactive” to “Pro-active” if meetings follow a focused agenda.

Keep Your Governance Group Small

While constructive ideas are helpful to gather from all areas of your business, it is recommended that document review is kept to a small group. Invite subject experts to meetings as necessary.

Develop Standard Email Templates

Design a standard email template used exclusively when announcing new manual updates to your teams. Emails should include specific page numbers and the section title of the effected segment.

Establish an Update Request Process

Standardize update requests throughout the business. A simple supervisor-level form connected to a central inbox can help filter requests and avoid repeats, if needed.